To add a new column "Address" of type 'char' to the Student table, the command is used as

ALTER TABLE Student ADD Address char;

To modify existing column of table, the **ALTER TABLE** command can be used with **MODIFY** clause like wise:

ALTER TABLE <table-name> MODIFY<column-name><data type><size>;

ALTER TABLE Student MODIFY Address char (25);

The above command will modify the address column of the Student table to now hold 25 characters.

The **ALTER** command can be used to rename an existing column in the following way :

ALTER TABLE <table-name> CHANGE old-column-name new-column-name new column definition;

For example to rename the column Address to City, the command is used as :

ALTER TABLE Student CHANGE Address City char(20);

The **ALTER** command can also be used to remove a column or all columns, for example to remove a particular column, the **DROP COLUMN** is used with the **ALTER TABLE** to remove a particular field. The command can be used as:

ALTER TABLE <table-name> DROP COLUMN <column-name>;

To remove the column City from the Student table, the command is used as :

ALTER TABLE Student DROP COLUMN City;

12.7.4.2 TRUNCATE command

The **TRUNCATE** command is used to delete all the rows from the table, the structure remains and the space is freed from the table. The syntax for **TRUNCATE** command is:

TRUNCATE TABLE table-name;

For example to delete all the records of the student table and delete the table the SQL statement is given as follows:

TRUNCATE TABLE Student;

The table Student is removed and the space is freed.

12.7.4.3 DROP TABLE command

The **DROP TABLE** command is used to remove a table from the database. If you drop a table, all the rows in the table is deleted and the table structure is removed from the database. Once a table is dropped we cannot get it back, so be careful while using **DROP TABLE** command.

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